

November, 2023
Memo

In the current world, social change is actively happening. If we take the subject of same sex marriage, we can see that it is now socially included as it was not in prior years. As Konefal points out, the government is a “key actor in social change” by passing new policies and laws. In the case of gender, the new law would be legalizing same sex marriage on official government documentation. By legitimizing marriage, the government is able to garner the support of people to continue as a functioning entity. Additionally, social change is more quickly facilitated because government policy is the one common factor everyone in society must adhere to, thus most will not rise against government policy and will gradually conform with it. In this way, government policies can steer society into new directions, whether or not those directions are positive or negative social change. Additionally, various economic factors and opportunities can bring about social change. As Konefal states, large corporations have a lot of sway over social practices. New technologies such as electronic devices were released by corporations, and marketing in the economy is a large part of bringing social change through new innovations. If a corporation releases a new device or car, they can market the products through employees, partnerships with other companies (such as requiring employees to use certain devices or have access to certain technologies), and have people with a lot of social presence like celebrities promote new products to convince society that people must use the new products. A large part of society is being “with the times” and having the same material goods as other people, so marketing plays a large part in bringing about social change through the use of new technology.

Question: Is it possible for there to be a time in the future where social change will not be required, or is social change an integral part of society even if the society has reached maximum efficiency and inclusion?